

Reimbursement Policy

TechNova Pvt. Ltd. — Internal Policy Document

Document Code	Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner
TN-FIN-102	1.8	01 April 2026	Finance Team

Purpose and Scope

This policy describes the process, timelines, and rules for claiming reimbursement of legitimate business expenses that an employee has paid for personally on behalf of TechNova Pvt. Ltd. It applies to all confirmed employees and covers claims such as client-related expenses, travel-related costs not covered by advance, work-from-home internet reimbursement, and approved ad-hoc purchases. For spending limits by category, see the Expense Policy; for travel-specific caps, see the Travel Policy.

General Principles

- Expenses must be genuine, business-related, reasonable in amount, and supported by a valid receipt or invoice.
- Claims should be submitted as close to the date of expense as possible, and no later than 60 days after the expense was incurred.
- An expense that required prior approval (see Expense Policy) but was not approved beforehand may be rejected or delayed pending manager justification.
- Reimbursements are processed only through the Expense Management module on the HR Portal; email or physical claims are not accepted.

What Can Be Claimed

Category	Examples
Client-related expenses	Client meals, local transport to client site, courier of business documents.
Travel top-ups	Expenses beyond a travel advance; see Travel Policy for booking-related items.
Work-from-home reimbursement	Internet bill reimbursement up to the monthly cap set in the Work From Home Policy.
Office supplies (ad hoc)	Small work-related purchases not available via the Admin supplies request, pre-approved by the manager.
Professional memberships	Approved subscriptions or memberships relevant to the employee's role.
Mobile/telecom reimbursement	Business use of personal mobile, up to the monthly cap for the employee's grade.

Submitting a Claim

- Log in to the HR Portal and go to "Expenses → New Claim".
- Select the expense category, enter the amount, date, and a short business justification.
- Attach a clear photo or scan of the original receipt/invoice; for amounts of INR 500 or more, an itemised receipt (not just a card slip) is required.
- Group related expenses from a single trip or event into one claim where possible, using the multi-line item feature.
- Submit the claim; it routes automatically to the reporting manager for approval.

Receipts and Documentation

Original receipts should be retained by the employee for 90 days after reimbursement in case of an audit query, even though only a digital copy is uploaded to the Portal. Expenses without a valid receipt may still be considered up to INR 500 per claim with a manager-approved self-declaration, used sparingly (e.g., for small cash payments where a receipt was not issued).

Reimbursement Policy vs. Expense Policy

This policy covers the process and timelines for an employee to be paid back for a business cost they have already incurred personally. The Expense Policy, a separate document, sets the spending limits, approved categories, and pre-approval rules for Company spending in general (including direct vendor payments and corporate card budgets). Read both together when planning a business expense: check the Expense Policy for whether and how much you may spend, and this policy for how to get reimbursed once you have spent it.

Special Reimbursement Scenarios

Scenario	Guidance
Relocation for a new role	One-time relocation assistance, where applicable, is agreed in writing by HR before the move and reimbursed against receipts for transport and temporary accommodation, capped per the offer/relocation letter.
Medical emergency during business travel	Employees may claim reasonable emergency medical costs not covered by travel insurance; contact the Travel Assistance line first and retain all receipts.
Client-site equipment purchase	Pre-approval from the manager and a business justification are required before purchase; retain the invoice in the purchaser's name where possible.
Team offsite or celebration expenses	Booked and paid centrally by Admin wherever feasible; individual reimbursement is only for pre-approved incidental costs.

Approval Workflow

Claim Amount	Approval Required
Up to INR 10,000	Reporting Manager
INR 10,001 – 50,000	Reporting Manager + Function Head
Above INR 50,000	Reporting Manager + Function Head + Finance Controller

Approvers are expected to act on a claim within 5 working days. Claims pending beyond 10 working days are automatically escalated to the next level approver by the system.

Payment Timeline

Once fully approved, reimbursements are paid out in the next payroll off-cycle disbursement run, which occurs every 15 days (on or around the 7th and 22nd of each month). Approved claims are typically credited to the employee's registered bank account within 15 calendar days of final approval.

Rejected or Returned Claims

- A claim may be returned for correction (e.g., missing receipt, unclear justification); the employee is notified and can resubmit within 15 days.
- A claim may be rejected outright if it falls outside policy (see Non-Reimbursable Expenses) or lacks a genuine business purpose.
- Employees may appeal a rejected claim by adding a comment with further justification, which routes the claim back to the approver for reconsideration.

Non-Reimbursable Expenses

- Personal purchases unrelated to work (groceries, personal subscriptions, personal travel).
- Fines, penalties, or late fees of any kind.
- Alcohol, unless part of an approved client-entertainment event within Expense Policy limits.
- Expenses already covered by a travel advance, per diem, or a Company-issued asset/subscription.
- Claims submitted more than 60 days after the expense date, except with documented exceptional circumstances approved by Finance.

Common Mistakes That Delay Reimbursement

- Uploading a blurred or partial photo of the receipt instead of a clear scan.
- Selecting the wrong expense category, which routes the claim to the wrong approver.
- Submitting a bulk claim with no line-item breakdown, making it hard for the approver to verify.
- Missing the required pre-approval for categories that need it under the Expense Policy.
- Waiting until close to the 60-day deadline, leaving no time to fix an issue if the claim is returned.

Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Submit accurate, timely claims with valid receipts and clear business justification.
Reporting Manager	Verify business relevance and approve/reject within 5 working days.
Finance Shared Services	Process approved claims for payment and run periodic compliance audits.
Finance Controller	Approve high-value claims above INR 50,000 and review recurring exceptions.

Foreign Currency Expenses

Expenses incurred in a foreign currency are converted to INR using the exchange rate on the transaction date, as shown on the employee's bank/card statement, or the RBI reference rate where a card statement is not available. The converted INR amount should be entered on the claim along with a copy of the statement or exchange receipt.

Corporate Card Users

Employees issued a TechNova corporate card (typically Sales and Leadership roles) should use it for eligible business expenses in preference to personal funds. Corporate card transactions must still be tagged with a business justification and receipt on the HR Portal within 7 days, but do not require a separate cash reimbursement since the Company is billed directly.

Audits and Compliance

Finance conducts periodic sample audits of submitted claims. Employees may be asked to produce the original receipt or additional context for a claim within the 90-day retention window. Deliberate submission of false or inflated claims is treated as a serious conduct matter under the Employee Handbook and may result in disciplinary action, recovery of amounts paid, and, where applicable, legal action.

Frequently Asked Questions

Question	Answer
How long does reimbursement take after approval?	Typically within 15 calendar days, paid in the next off-cycle disbursement run (7th or 22nd of the month).
What if I lost my receipt?	Claims without a receipt are considered only up to INR 500 with a manager-approved self-declaration.
Can I combine multiple expenses into one claim?	Yes, using multiple line items within a single claim for the same trip or event.

Question	Answer
What is the deadline to submit a claim?	60 days from the date the expense was incurred.

Contact and Escalation

For questions on this policy or a stuck claim, contact the Finance Shared Services team at expenses@technova.example or raise a ticket via "Help → Ask Finance" on the HR Portal.

Document Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Change
1.3	Apr 2022	Digitised claims via HR Portal; removed paper forms.
1.6	Apr 2024	Introduced tiered approval thresholds by claim amount.
1.8	Apr 2026	Added corporate card and foreign currency guidance.